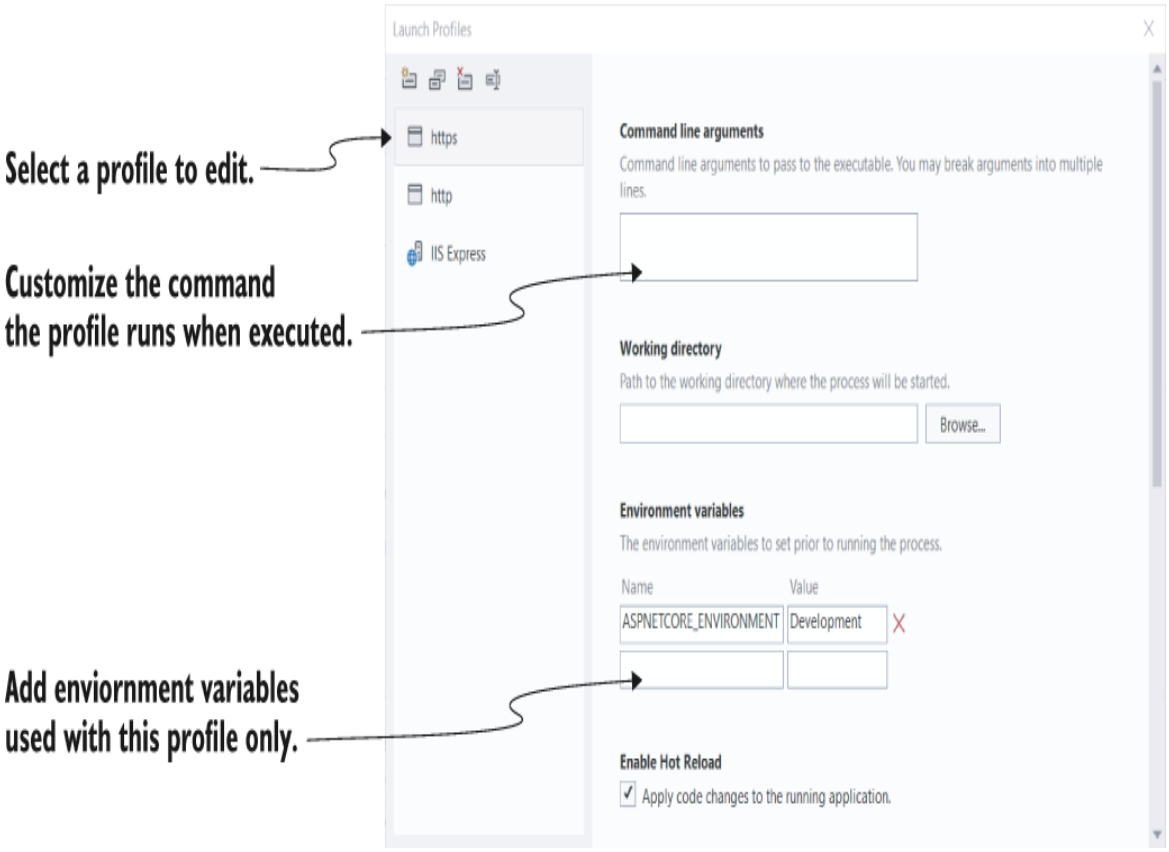


Figure 10.8 You can use Visual Studio to edit the launchSettings.json file, if you prefer. Changes will be mirrored between the launchSettings.json file and the Properties dialog box.

The launchSettings.json file is intended for local development only; by default, the file isn't deployed to production servers. Although you can deploy and use the file in production, doing so generally isn't worth the hassle. Environment variables are a better fit.

One final trick I've used to set the environment in production is to use command-line arguments. You could set the environment to staging like this:

```
dotnet run --no-launch-profile --environment Staging
```

Note that you also have to pass `--no-launch-profile` if there's a launchSettings.json file; otherwise, the values in the file take precedence.